

# Jessica M. Alexander

 jessb0t.github.io  
 jessb0t  
 jessica.alexander@utexas.edu  
 tinyurl.com/GSjma  
 jessmalexander  
 @je55bot

## Education

- anticip. 2028 **Ph.D. in Neurolinguistics**, The University of Texas at Austin  
Research topic: Impact of emotional prosody on cognitive and neural function of the listener  
Methodologies: electroencephalography (EEG), signal processing, machine learning, statistics  
Advisor and Committee Chair: Dr. Fernando Llanos  
Committee: Dr. Rajka Smiljanić, Dr. Lori Holt, Dr. David Quinto-Pozos
- 2004 **B.A. in Linguistics** with distinction, Boston University, *summa cum laude*  
Thesis: “Frequency, Prosody, and French Liaison: Testing Bybee’s Hypothesis”  
Advisor: Dr. Jonathan Barnes

## Publications

- Alexander, J. M.** and Llanos, F. (2025). High-arousal emotional speech enhances speech intelligibility and emotion recognition in noise. *J. Acoust. Soc. Am.*, 157(6), 4085-4096.  
[doi.org/10.1121/10.0036812](https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0036812)
- Alexander, J. M.** and Buzzell, G. A. (2024). Emotional Context and Predictability in Naturalistic Reading Aloud. *Emotion*, 24(3), 617-627. [doi.org/10.1037/emo0001298](https://doi.org/10.1037/emo0001298)

## Conferences

- Alexander, J. M.** and Llanos, F. (2025, 12-14 September) Effects of emotional prosody on sentence intelligibility and emotion recognition in vocoded speech. [Poster presentation]. 17<sup>th</sup> Annual Meeting of the Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Washington, D.C., USA.
- Alexander, J. M.** and Llanos, F. (2024, 18-22 November) Benefits of emotional prosody for sentence intelligibility and emotion recognition in speech-shaped noise: acoustic and perceptual basis. [Flashtalk]. 187<sup>th</sup> Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America, Virtual Meeting.
- Sahar, L., **Alexander, J. M.**, Buzzell, G.A. (2024, 1 April) Unfamiliarity reveals prosodic correlates of social anxiety: Evidence from naturalistic reading. [Poster presentation]. GSAW Scholarly Forum at Florida International University, Miami, FL, USA.
- Alexander, J. M.**, Lopez-Nuñez, A., Rodriguez, B. M., Duncombe, A. N., Malykke, S. B., Buzzell, G. A. (2022, October 6-8). Effects of Lexical Valence and Emotional (In)Congruency in Naturalistic Reading Aloud. [Poster presentation]. 14<sup>th</sup> Annual Meeting of the Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Philadelphia, PA, USA.

---

## Grants & Fellowships

- 2024, 2026 **Carlota Smith Fellowship**, UT Austin [\$1525]
- 2024-2025 **Scholars Lab Fellowship**, UT Austin [\$3000]
- 2024 **Hertz Fellowship Finalist**, Fannie and John Hertz Foundation
- 2001-2004 **Merit Scholarship**, Boston University [50% coverage of tuition]

---

## Professional Experience [curated for relevance]

May-Aug 2026 **Ozlo Sleep**

*Technology company behind Sleepbuds, a nextgen hearable engineered to improve sleep*

### Neurotechnology Intern

- Performed modeling, analysis, and simulation of neural data to characterize sleep and inform product engineering decisions
- Built standalone scripts and updated existing data processing pipelines with noise reduction and signal extraction algorithms
- Drafted scientific reports on topics such as: in-ear responses to standard EEG paradigms for evoked and sustained responses, machine learning approaches to sleep staging, neural dynamics of post-sleep awakening and associated sleep inertia
- Conducted prototype testing and analysis

2021-2023 **Neural Dynamics of Control Laboratory at Florida International University**

*Cognitive neuroscience research lab focused on cognitive control, self-monitoring, and social anxiety in naturalistic task settings (PI: Dr. George Buzzell)*

### Lab Manager

- Organized launch activities for \$2.5M NIMH grant (R01 MH131637), including hiring staff, establishing procurement lines, coordinating translations of consent forms and study questionnaires, and ensuring administrative compliance for all study team members
- Contributed to the design, piloting, and drafting of successful \$257K NIMH grant (R21 MH131928)
- Supported PI, graduate students, and research assistants to assure efficient timelines, clear procedures, quality of research, and overall lab organization (across GitHub, Google Drive, Slack and the FIU HPC)
- Managed IRB protocols (~10) for all active studies, including initial submission, amendments, and compliance monitoring
- Recruited, interviewed, and trained undergraduate research assistants
- Assisted with management of lab budget, including expenditure tracking and forecasting
- Facilitated NIMH research award program (R01, R21) grant applications with organizational administration and editorial feedback
- Actively collaborated in the creation of study protocols, data preprocessing, and analysis scripts

2011-2021 **Idem Translations, Inc.** [acquired by Powerling in 2025]

*Largest independently owned translation company in the United States that specializes in serving the life sciences community, from preclinical research to postmarket surveillance*

### VP, Quality & Operations (2014-2021)

- Multi-functional role on geographically-diverse, 20-person team
- Facilitated daily operations and supported company-wide improvement projects
- Monitored metrics to analyze business performance and quality initiatives; translated data findings to top management to inform strategic decision-making
- Created informative, actionable reporting to highlight business strengths and opportunities

- Communicated complex quality system issues to management and production staff
- Represented production group as interface with database manager for increased data access and UX improvements to homegrown, SQL-based, project- and business-management tool
- Recruited and trained new project managers on system tools, processes, and expectations
- Oversaw recruitment and relationship maintenance for pool of 700+ freelance vendors
- Administered toolkit of technological resources available to project management team

#### Director, Quality (2012-2014)

- Built data funnels and developed analytics to shift organization from intuition- to fact-based decision-making
- Rewrote full set of operational procedures to achieve certification to two additional ISO standards
- Forged group dynamic obsessed with getting every detail right in the service of our customers

#### Project Manager (2011-2012)

- Managed life sciences translation projects (quotation, budgeting, schedule, vendor coordination, client interface)

#### 2007-2011 Self-Employed Translator and Editor

- Managed all aspects of sole proprietorship, translating French-to-English and Chinese-to-English documents with a focus on marketing copy, creative content, and literary endeavors
- Edited creative English content for grammar, style, voice, and readability

## Skills (1 dark circle = basic familiarity; 5 dark circles = capabilities exceeding standard competence)

### Programming:

|       |        |        |       |       |       |       |
|-------|--------|--------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| R     | Python | MATLAB | Praat | SQL   | Shell | Bash  |
| ●●●●● | ●●●●●  | ●●●●●  | ●●●●● | ●●●●● | ●●●●● | ●●●●● |

### Data Analysis:

|    |       |       |       |                      |       |
|----|-------|-------|-------|----------------------|-------|
| ML | ●●●●● | Excel | ●●●●● | DSP                  | ●●●●● |
| DL | ●●●●● | NLP   | ●●●●● | Multi-Channel Arrays | ●●●●● |

### Organization:

|              |       |           |       |          |       |
|--------------|-------|-----------|-------|----------|-------|
| Google Drive | ●●●●● | Zotero    | ●●●●● | Markdown | ●●●●● |
| Git          | ●●●●● | Linux HPC | ●●●●● | Acrobat  | ●●●●● |

### Data Collection:

|        |       |          |          |         |
|--------|-------|----------|----------|---------|
| REDCap | SONA  | PsychoPy | Pavlovia | Gorilla |
| ●●●●●  | ●●●●● | ●●●●●    | ●●●●●    | ●●●●●   |

### Presentation:

|        |       |            |          |           |        |
|--------|-------|------------|----------|-----------|--------|
| ggplot | Word  | PowerPoint | InDesign | WordPress | Quarto |
| ●●●●●  | ●●●●● | ●●●●●      | ●●●●●    | ●●●●●     | ●●●●●  |

### Languages:

|          |                                        |
|----------|----------------------------------------|
| English  | ●●●●● (native)                         |
| French   | ●●●●● (fluent)                         |
| Mandarin | ●●●●● (intermediate, spoken & written) |

---

## Honors & Awards

- 2004 **BU College Prize and MFL Award for Excellence**, Boston University
- 2004 **Phi Beta Kappa** induction
- 2004 **Shmuel Traub Translation Prize**, Boston University [translations from Colette's *La femme cachée*]
- 2003 **Barbara Argote Junior Award in Linguistics**, Boston University
- 2003 **Phi Sigma Iota** induction

---

## Service/Volunteering

- 2026-pres. Ad hoc reviewer: *Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, *Phonetica*
- 2026 "Working with Color in Data Visualizations Using R and ggplot2," workshop presenter
- 2025 "Making Beautiful Plots in R's ggplot2," workshop presenter
- 2024-pres. Cognition and Natural Sensory Processing Initiative (CNSP), volunteer organizer
- 2024-pres. UT Austin College of Liberal Arts Graduate Student Advisory Council, nominated member
- 2023-pres. Neuroling Resources (compilation of open, neurolinguistic datasets), curator
- 2023-pres. Skype a Scientist, volunteer scientist

---

## Relevant Coursework

### University of Texas at Austin (2023-present)

- Matrix and Tensor Algorithms for Data
- Programming and Data Analysis for Modern Neuroscience
- EEG Methods in Psycholinguistics
- Computational Methods in Linguistics
- Anatomy and Physiology of the Auditory System
- Speech and Audio Processing
- Speech Perception Across Listeners, Speakers, and Environments
- Prosody and Tone
- Bilingual Brain
- Phonetics
- Neurolinguistics
- Syntax
- Phonology
- Semantics

### Online Continuing Education (2021-2022)

- Basic Statistics (Coursera)
- Inferential Statistics (Coursera)
- Fundamentals of Neuroscience: The Electrical Properties of the Neuron (HarvardX)
- Fundamentals of Neuroscience: Neurons and Networks (HarvardX)
- Fundamentals of Neuroscience: The Brain (HarvardX)
- Neuromatch Academy, Computational Neuroscience (July 11-29, 2022)

(Last updated: 2026-08-22)